

Matt Hanson

Writer | Developer | Data Reporter

EXPERIENCE

Omaha World-Herald, Omaha, NE — *Data Fellow; Reporting Intern*

August 2017 – December 2017; May 2018 - Present

As a part-time fellow at the Omaha World-Herald, my duties include researching potential stories and news apps, writing my own data stories and helping my editor maintain Django-based apps on dataomaha.com. In the summer of 2018, I joined the news desk as a reporting intern.

The Buffalo News, Buffalo, NY — *Data Reporting Intern*

June 2017 - August 2017

Cleaned and analyzed 1.6 million rows of parking ticket data to produce a package that included a story I wrote, an interactive map and database and stories from other reporters. Also worked early morning breaking news shifts for two weeks and wrote two movie reviews.

The Wounds of Whiteclay, Lincoln, NE — *Chief Developer and Data Reporter*

August 2016 - May 2017

As one of 11 students asked to join a yearlong Depth Reporting class at UNL, I taught myself how to code in order to create www.woundsofwhiteclay.com. I also cleaned, analyzed and created graphics from data on the Pine Ridge Reservation in South Dakota and the neighboring town of Whiteclay, Nebraska. The finished product became the first college publication to win the grand prize from the Robert F. Kennedy Journalism Awards, beating outlets like HBO and the New Yorker to take home the award.

EDUCATION

University of Nebraska-Lincoln, Lincoln, NE — *Bachelor's of Journalism*

August 2015 - May 2018

Came to UNL in the fall of 2015 to start a journalism major at the College of Journalism and Mass Communications.

Semester at Sea

Spring 2015

Traveled to 15 countries in four months, taking classes on a cruise ship through the University of Virginia.

Texas Christian University, Fort Worth, TX

August 2013 - December 2014

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SKILLS

Writing, reporting, photography, editing

HTML, Javascript/jQuery and CSS

Computational data analysis (mostly Python, with some Excel and R)

Data normalization/cleaning (OpenRefine)

Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Lightroom,

Microsoft Office

AWARDS

Robert F. Kennedy Journalism Awards:

Grand prize for class investigation into predatory liquor trade in Whiteclay, Nebraska. First college to win in 49 years of the award.

Kansas Scholastic Press Association:

1st place Feature, 1st place News, 3rd place Review, all for the 2012-2013 school year

National Federation of Press Women:

2nd place Feature, national write-off for the 2012-2013 school year.

REFERENCES

Matt Waite

Data journalism professor and UCARE advisor
(402) 802-5202

Jeff Robb

Editor at Omaha World-Herald
(402) 444-1128

Dow Tate

Journalism teacher and advisor at Shawnee Mission East High School
(913) 620-2389